Unit 30 - Digital Graphics
Assignment 3 - Creating Digital Graphics

Introduction

Scenario / Vocational Context: *SuperSkills Studios are very happy with your knowledge of digital graphics and would like to give you your first project. The company has been approached to create a new brochure for Highlands College and their Level 3 BTEC in IT. They would like a 4 A4 page brochure that consists of:*

-A Front Page
-Course Details
-College Facilities
-Contact Details

The brochure must contain the Highlands College logo as well as fit with college policy on equality and diversity. The brochure will be printed as well as used online.

The brochure must contain at least one image you have captured yourself.

You must create the brochure, and document the process that was used to create the final product.

Task 1

(U30:P3) - Demonstrate the use of editing tools to edit and manipulate images

Task description: *You must document the use of your use of editing tools in order to manipulate and create digital graphics during making the brochure.*

At a minimum you need to ensure you document the following:

The use of a camera to incorporate a photo

In my brochure, I will include an image which I will capture of the college with the camera on my smartphone, which has an 8.3 megapixel camera (4k resolution). Below I will show the image which I have captured and will use on the brochure,

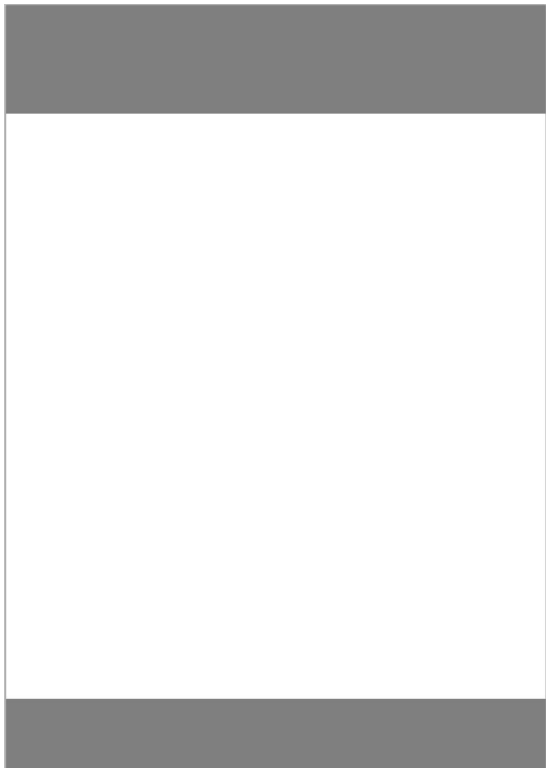


This is the image that I have captured with my camera. With this image, I am going to manipulate the other images including this one to my liking so that it can be used on my final brochure design.

The image that I have captured is outside the “Cafe connect” in the college campus, this image I will hopefully use for the “college facilities” section of the brochure. However, I won't be doing much manipulation with this image, and I will only use the resize tool to make it fit within an empty space in the brochure.

Creating a graphic/line art/background from scratch

When I started making the brochure, I made a simple foundation from graphics and line art so that it is easier to use content on it. Also, the layer feature on photoshop makes this layout a lot easier to use with content due to the ability of having it on different layers of different images and other content.



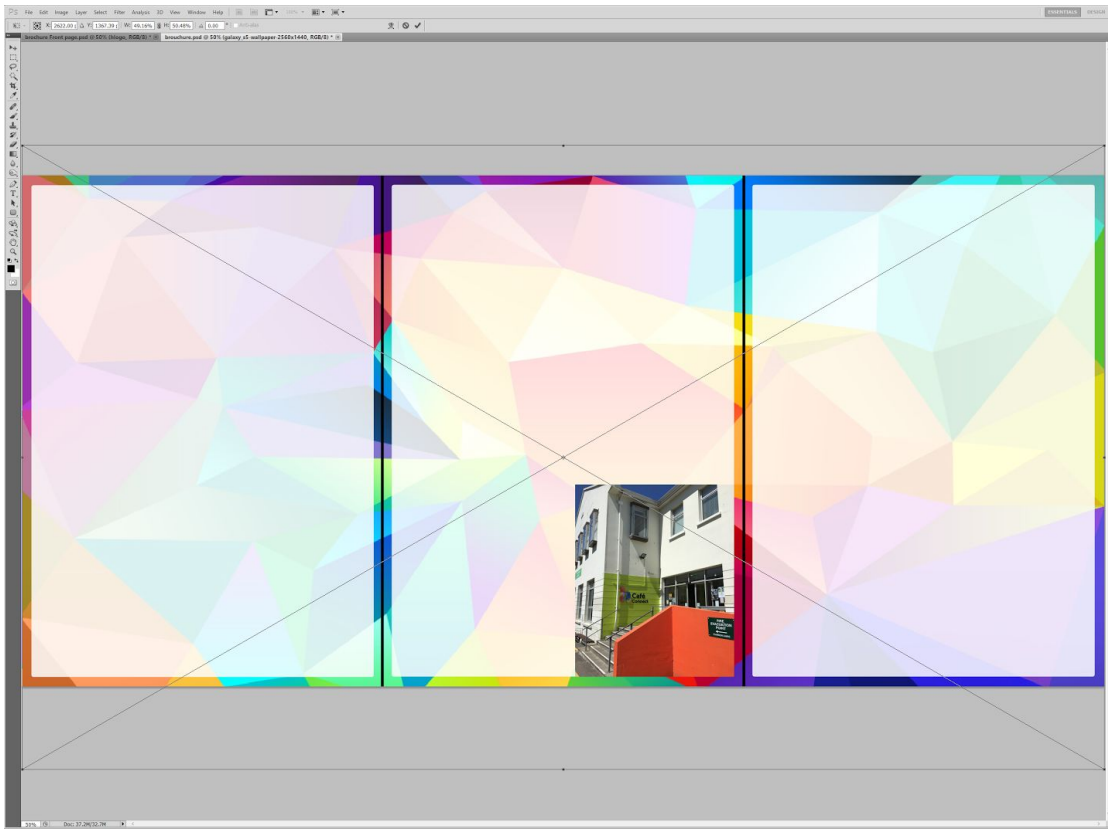


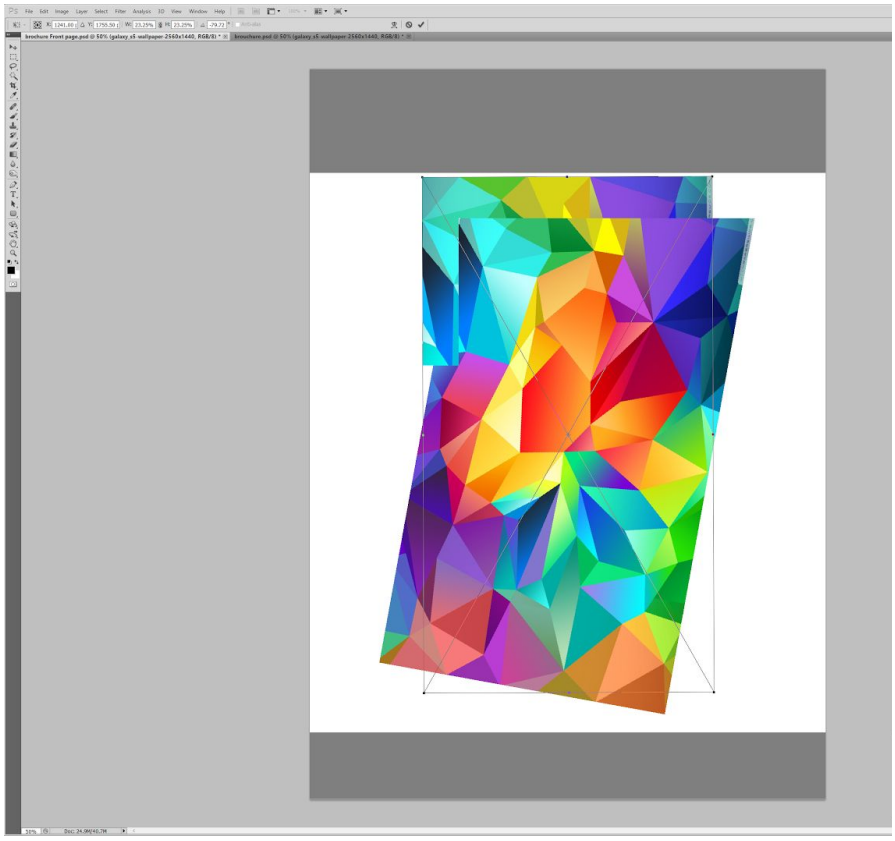
In the screenshots above I have created a layout in which I will use for my brochure. I did this because it would give me a lot of room for creativity while still keeping the look of the brochure in mind, basically giving me more freedom in creativity without going off topic from a brochure.

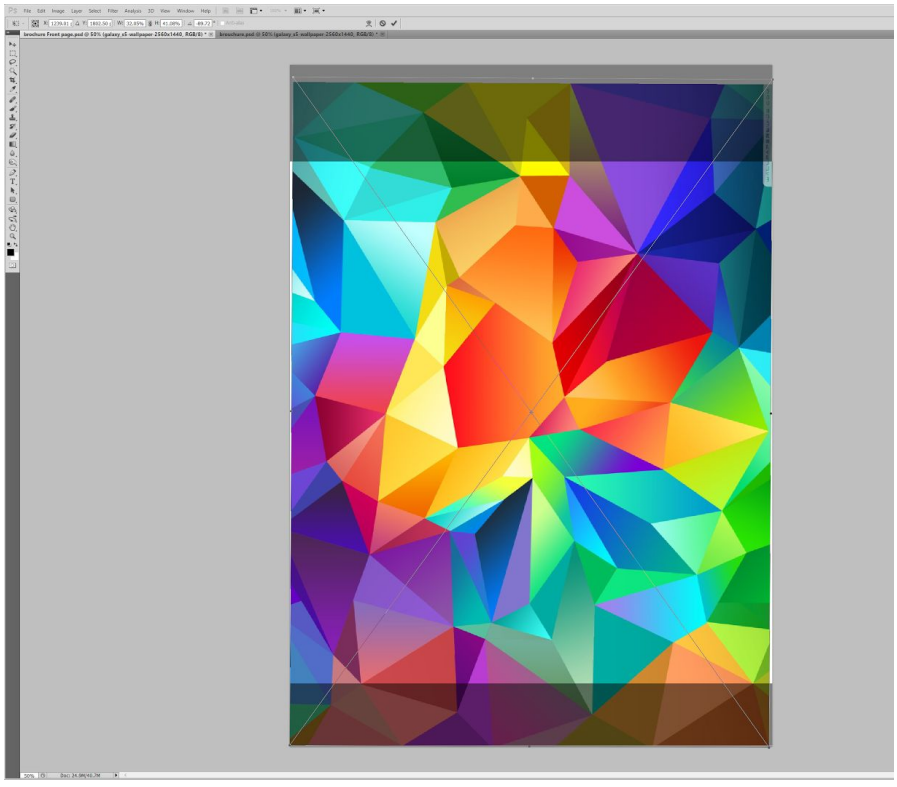
This background layout also makes it easier to remove unwanted content which is not needed or could be too distracting for the user. So, this type of graphic and line art could prove to be very advantageous with the creation of the brochure.

At least 2 tools out of – rotate, flip, resize, crop

As I was making the brochure, I gathered an already existing image for the background, so I cropped it, rotated it and resized it to fit on my brochure.





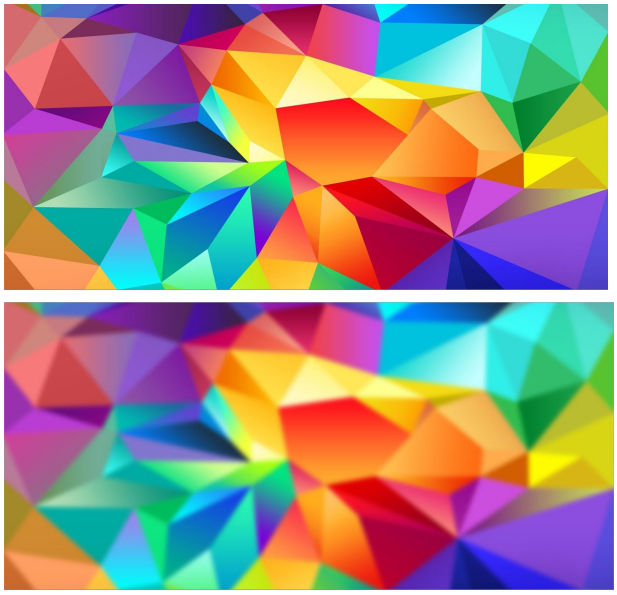


In the screenshots above, I have manipulated the images (such as cropping, scaling and rotating) so they would fit on the canvas size of the pages for my brochure.

I did this because it would make the image look less pixelated and look more professional compared to just placing the images and leaving them, basically giving the brochure a more aesthetically pleasing look and be less frustrating to look at.

A special effect

When I finished adding the background to the brochure, I decided to add some special effects to make it less distracting when people are looking at it. So, I decided that the special effect that I would use is the blur effect, specifically the gaussian blur.





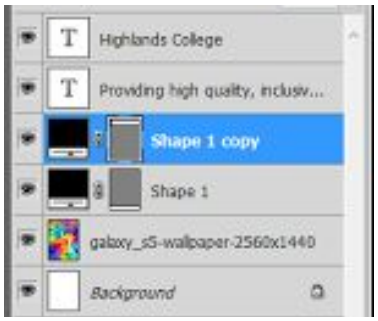


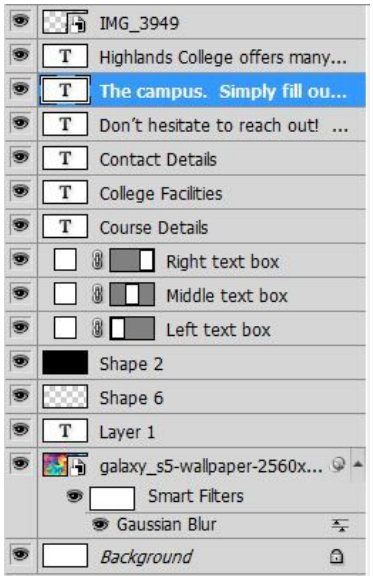
In the screenshots above, I have created blurring special effects for each background for the pages on the brochure. I did this because it would give the user a much easier experience when reading and looking at the brochure, basically it makes the background stand out less, making the rest of the content stand out more.

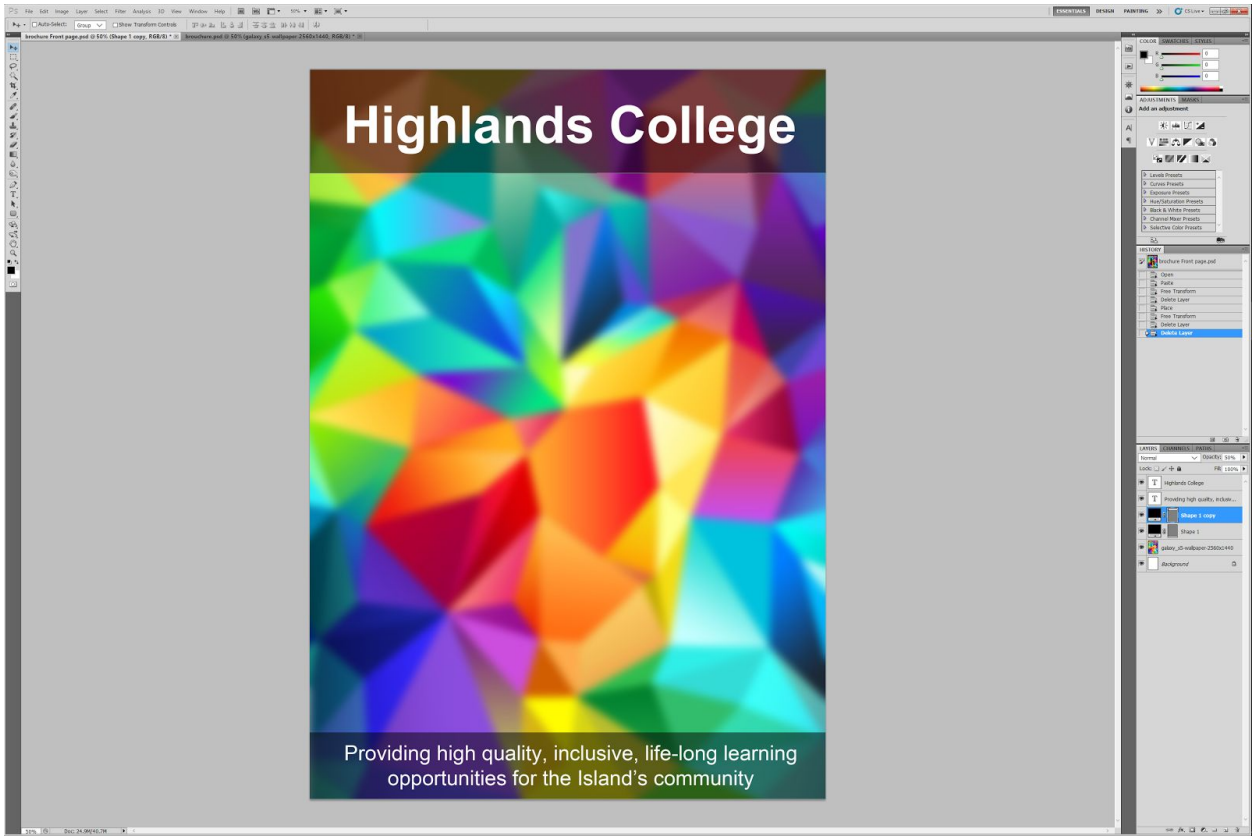
This background layout also makes it stand out less when the user is reading. So, this type of special effect makes reading less distracting, and for some, painful to read due to the vast amount of content that is standing out.

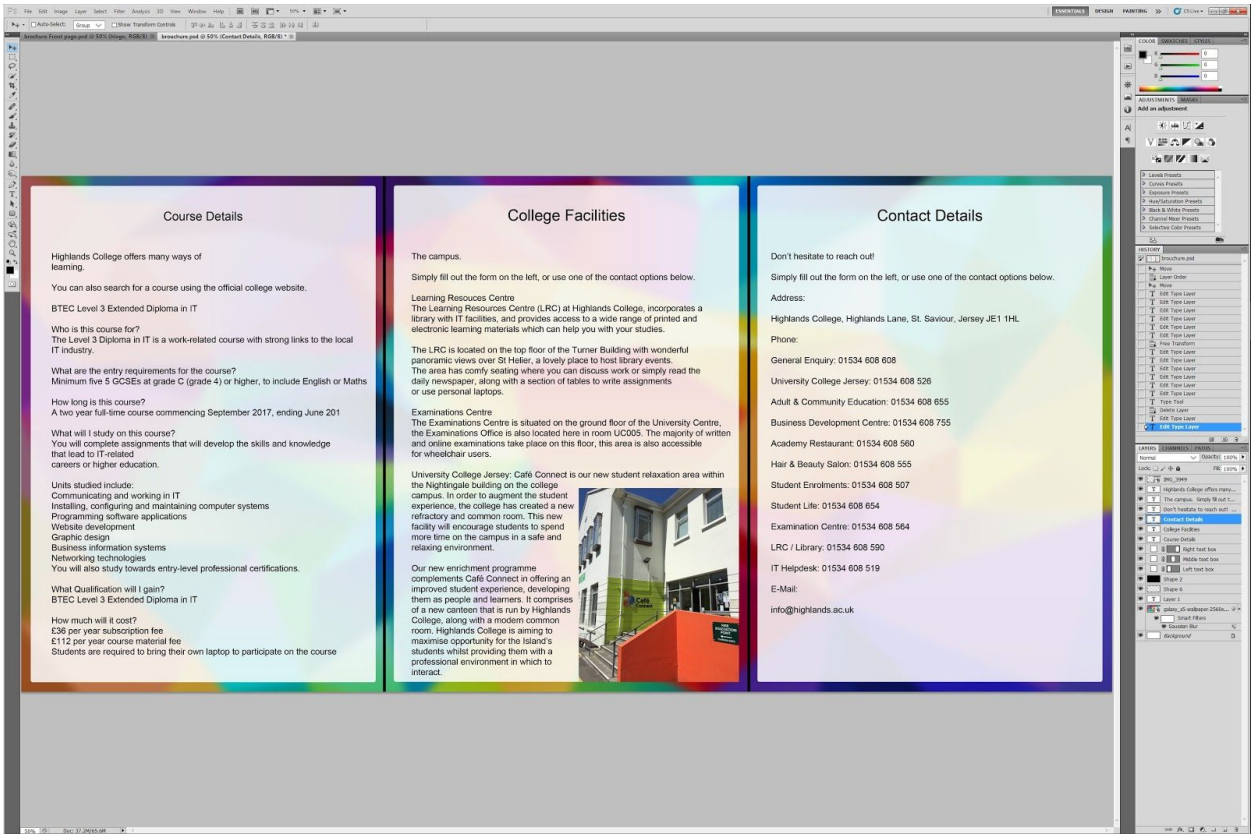
A use of layering

As I was adding all the content needed for the brochure, I started using the layering a lot more to my advantage. Which made it a lot easier to sort different bits of content, allowing me to put any content I desired on top of a different bit of content.




IMG_3949
Highlands College offers many...
The campus. Simply fill ou...
Don't hesitate to reach out! ...
Contact Details
College Facilities
Course Details
Right text box
Middle text box
Left text box
Shape 2
Shape 6
Layer 1
galaxy_s5-wallpaper-2560x...
Smart Filters
Gaussian Blur
Background


Highlands College
Providing high quality, inclusive, life-long learning opportunities for the Island's community



In the screenshots above, I have created most of the content needed for the brochure, each with their own layer. I did this because it would give me the ability to move any bit of the content I want around. Basically, it makes it easier for me to move the things I want anywhere I want.

Having these layers not only makes me move the content I want, but also remove it. So, if I find content that I don't think would be useful to have or doesn't fit within the user needs, I would remove it with ease due to the layers that each specific content has.

<u>An advanced technique (background aware fill, magic wand selection, advanced filter etc.)</u>

When I started finishing the content of the brochure, I started getting a logo to put in the front page, which required the use of another existing image. With the tools such as the magic wand selection, I could use it to manipulate the image so it could blend in with the brochure a lot.



In the screenshots above, I have inserted a logo of the Highlands College, using the magic wand tool to select the white background. I did this because it would give me the ability to remove the selected area of the image. Basically, it makes it easier for me to remove the unneeded parts of an image.

Having the magic selection tool not only makes me remove the content I want, but also move the selected. So, if I find an image that I think would be useful when apart or if it doesn't fit within a specific area, I would move it with ease due to the sophistication of the magic selection tool and other forms of selection tools.

Changing an existing image

After I used the magic wand tool to select the image, I removed the white background so it would make it a lot more aesthetically pleasing. With the help of tools such as the magic wand selection, it gave me the ability to do this with ease.





In the screenshots above, I have used the magic wand tool to select the white background of this image. I did this because it would look very unprofessional and displeasing if I left the white background on for the user to see. Basically, it makes it a lot better to look at the brochure if it didn't have the white background on that image.

Removing this background would not only blend it in better, but also not annoy anyone who is looking at the brochure. So, the brochure can bee seen as a product that has effort put into and that it would be worth looking at, instead of the user passing it off as a badly made graphic.

Task 2

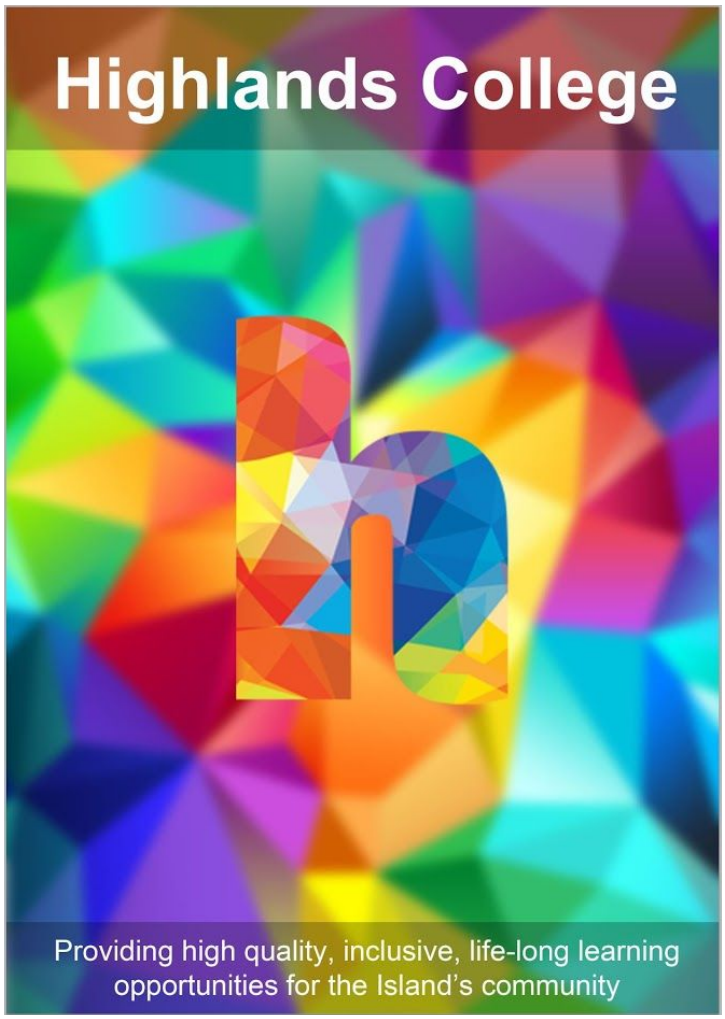
(U30:P4) - create original graphic images to meet a defined user need

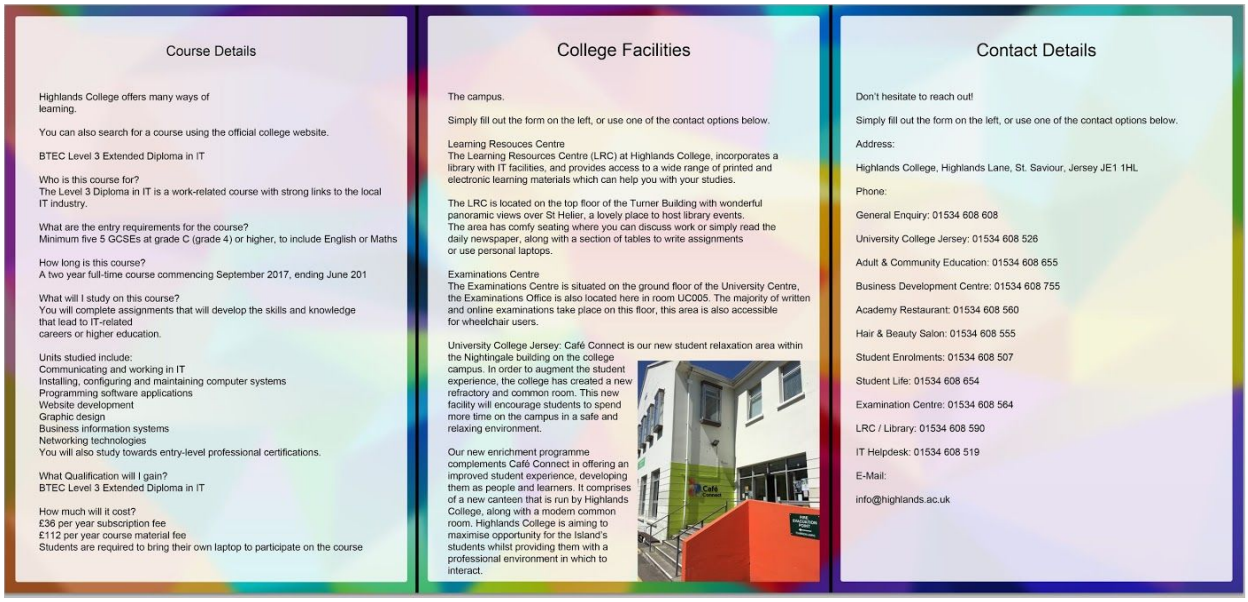
Task description: *Showcase your final design.*

You are first to introduce the brochure and the parameters of your creation. This should cover the following:

Client Needs.
Target Audience.
Constraints.
Destined Output Media.

Ensure that you include all 4 pages of your brochure and that they are presented in way that is easy to see.





Course Details

Highlands College offers many ways of learning.

You can also search for a course using the official college website.

BTEC Level 3 Extended Diploma in IT

Who is this course for?
The Level 3 Diploma in IT is a work-related course with strong links to the local IT industry.

What are the entry requirements for the course?
Minimum five 5 GCSEs at grade C (grade 4) or higher, to include English or Maths

How long is this course?
A two year full-time course commencing September 2017, ending June 201

What will I study on this course?
You will complete assignments that will develop the skills and knowledge that lead to IT-related careers or higher education.

Units studied include:
Communicating and working in IT
Installing, configuring and maintaining computer systems
Programming software applications
Website development
Graphic design
Business information systems
Networking technologies
You will also study towards entry-level professional certifications.

What Qualification will I gain?
BTEC Level 3 Extended Diploma in IT

How much will it cost?
£36 per year subscription fee
£112 per year course material fee
Students are required to bring their own laptop to participate on the course

College Facilities

The campus.

Simply fill out the form on the left, or use one of the contact options below.

Learning Resouces Centre
The Learning Resources Centre (LRC) at Highlands College, incorporates a library with IT facilities, and provides access to a wide range of printed and electronic learning materials which can help you with your studies.

The LRC is located on the top floor of the Turner Building with wonderful panoramic views over St Helier, a lovely place to host library events. The area has comfy seating where you can discuss work or simply read the daily newspaper, along with a section of tables to write assignments or use personal laptops.

Examinations Centre
The Examinations Centre is situated on the ground floor of the University Centre, the Examinations Office is also located here in room UC005. The majority of written and online examinations take place on this floor, this area is also accessible for wheelchair users.

University College Jersey: Café Connect is our new student relaxation area within the Nightingale building on the college campus. In order to augment the student experience, the college has created a new refractory and common room. This new facility will encourage students to spend more time on the campus in a safe and relaxing environment.

Our new enrichment programme complements Café Connect in offering an improved student experience, developing them as people and learners. It comprises of a new canteen that is run by Highlands College, along with a modern common room. Highlands College is aiming to maximise opportunity for the Island's students whilst providing them with a professional environment in which to interact.

Contact Details

Don't hesitate to reach out!

Simply fill out the form on the left, or use one of the contact options below.

Address:

Highlands College, Highlands Lane, St. Saviour, Jersey JE1 1HL

Phone:

General Enquiry: 01534 608 608

University College Jersey: 01534 608 526

Adult & Community Education: 01534 608 655

Business Development Centre: 01534 608 755

Academy Restaurant: 01534 608 560

Hair & Beauty Salon: 01534 608 555

Student Enrolments: 01534 608 507

Student Life: 01534 608 654

Examination Centre: 01534 608 564

LRC / Library: 01534 608 590

IT Helpdesk: 01534 608 519

E-Mail:

info@highlands.ac.uk

Client Needs

My client's name is SuperSkills Studios and they have a business which produces graphics for other businesses and organisations. The business gave me the task of producing a brochure for Highlands College and their Level 3 BTEC in IT.

With this they want me to create a front page, course details, college facilities and contact details. It is required that the brochure contains the Highlands College logo and it has to fit within the college policy on equality and diversity, which it will then be used online and printed out.

As you can see in the screenshots above, I have fit the client needs for the production of the brochure. For instance, I have included a front page,a course details page, a college facilities page and a contact details page for the structure of my brochure.

For the content, I have met the requirements of having a Highlands College logo on the front page and I have also met the requirement of fitting within the college policy on quality and diversity, because it doesn't mention anything that conflicts against that and it doesn't promote inequality and uniformity.

Target Audience

For my brochure, there are 3 different target audiences which I have produced this graphic for, and they are: visitors of the college, students enrolling in the IT course and other staff who want to find out about the IT course.

For the visitors of the college, they will be using this brochure for finding out about the basic questions about the course, facilities around the college and even the contact details to find out more about the college.

For the students enrolling in the IT course, they can also find out the frequently asked questions of the IT course. Also, the contact details to the college if they plan on enrolling or finding out more about the IT course.

For the staff who want to find out more about the IT course, they can also find out the frequently asked questions of the IT course. They can also see what the course consists of by either visiting the details on the contact details page.

As you can see in the screenshots above, I have fit the client needs for the target audience for the brochure. For instance, I have included information in the pages of the brochure which helps the target audience with their needs, such as: finding out about the course, finding the facilities around the college and finding out the contact details for the college.

For the content, I have met the requirements of having information which would be useful for the target audience to use. With information such as: FAQs about the course, different forms of contact details for the college and information about the facilities of the college. This fits within the requirements because it mentions the most common needs that a student, visitor or member of staff would need.

Constraints

For my brochure, there are 3 some constraints in which I had to keep mind of when creating the brochure, and they are: it has to be an A4 page sized brochure, to only contain 4 pages and it has to be in the college policy on equality and diversity.

For the page being A4 sized, the brochure will have to be the size of an A4 page because they are planning on using it online and printing it out for use, which means they have to be this specific size so it could be used on these output medias.

For the brochure to only contain 4 pages, they wanted the brochure to be short and informative, therefore only having a 4 page limit. Therefore, it means that the brochure cannot be below or above 4 pages.

For the policy on equality and diversity, the college wants to express a good message and not promote a bad reputation. That is why they need to have a policy of equality and diversity on the brochure, or at least not promote any forms of inequality and uniformity.

As you can see in the screenshots above, I have fit the client needs for the constraints set out for the production of the brochure. For instance, I have kept in mind the constraints that the brochure should physically have, such as: making the brochure to be the size of an A4 paper so it could be available for future use and only having 4 different pages which contains a variation of information of the college and course.

For the content, I have met the requirements of having information which fits within the college policy, by not conflicting against it. With the brochure only containing information which is needed, such as the content on the a front page, course details, college facilities and contact details without any other form of useless information or promotion against the policy. This

means that it does fit within the college policy and does not conflict against any policies, especially ones that would be seen as offensive.

Destined Output Media

For my brochure, there are different destined output media which the company has set out for me, and they are: making sure that the brochure can be used online and making sure that the brochure can be printed using a printer.

For the ability to use the brochure online, SuperSkills Studios have mentioned that the brochure will be used online. So, the brochure will have to be tailored to be used online without any errors, and giving the user the ability to look through all pages in detail.

For the ability for the brochure to be printed out, SuperSkills Studios have mentioned that the brochure will be printed out. So, the brochure will have to be an A4 sized paper to be printed out, making the brochure a compact size while also giving the user the ability to look through all pages in detail.

As you can see in the screenshots above, I have fit the needs for the destined output media for the brochure. For instance, I have made the brochure so that it fits the destined output media, such as: I made sure that the file type is suitable to be used online when the brochure is saved and that the brochure page size fits within the printing recommendation.

Task 3

(U30:M2) - justify the software, tools, file format, image resolution and colour depth used for creating graphic images

Task description: *Create a document that tracks the process used to create the poster / brochure. Making sure that you justify why you have used the following:*

Software

The software that I have used to create the brochure is Adobe's Photoshop. The reason that I picked this program for the production of the brochure is due to the wide functionality and ease of use that the software offers.

I have learned and felt comfortable with using the tools and the functionality of Photoshop and I also gotten used to the UI of the software, which made the production of the brochure a lot easier when compared to my previous experience.

Since Photoshop allows the use of layers, it gave me the ability to massively improve the editing and it also allowed me to create a brochure of higher quality. With these layers, I was able to add multiple imaged on top of other images which has really helped me with my editing.

Tools

The software tools that I have used was the resize, crop, magic wand selection, rectangle/rounded rectangle tool, text tool and other blending options for images.

With the resize tool and crop, it gave me the ability to manipulate images while keeping the quality of the images at a good standard. I used this because it proved to be very useful for fitting images for my brochure, helping me tailor it to look professional.

With the magic wand selection, it gave me the ability to selects areas of an image which I do not want to include or I feel get in the way. I used this because it also proved to be very useful for manipulating the images on my brochure, also helping me tailor it to look more professional.

WIth the rectangle/rounded rectangle tool, it gave me the ability to add boxes to make areas stand out or darken some areas of the brochure, so I could include text and images without the reader having trouble when looking through the brochure.

With the text tool, it gave me the ability to add information to the brochure, which is undoubtedly very important to have in a brochure. I used this because it proved to be very useful for filling the brochure with useful information, helping me make the brochure to meet its intended purpose.

With the blending options, it gave me the ability to manipulate the image I have selected. Basically, with this option I was able to make images transparent, colour overlay and other options which I feel would make the brochure much more professional and easy to read.

The hardware tools that I have used was the keyboard and mouse. Both of these tools were very useful in the editing of the image. Firstly, the mouse allowed me to somewhat accurately draw lines and easily click and drag when needed.

The mouse I used was a laser mouse, thus gave me very accurate control over editing. However, the mouse isn't as natural to use when drawing out on an image, but the brochure did not require such precise movement, the closes to precise is using the quick selection tool.

The keyboard allowed me to perform shortcuts such as removing the last thing I did with 'Ctrl+Z'. Without the keyboard I would not be able to perform shortcuts making the editing process a lot longer and more challenging.

File Format

After editing the image on Photoshop, I saved the file in both JPEG and PNG format.

The reason that I used the JPEG format is due to the fact it has a small file size, allowing me to move and upload the image to different places at a decent speed. The JPEG format also has a good colour depth, meaning that I can keep the quality of the image.

The final reason for choosing JPEG is the compression rate. With this, I am able to compress the image for a smaller file size, which would allow me to transfer or upload the image faster.

The reason that I used the PNG format is due to the fact it has a much higher quality image when compared to JPEG, which makes the brochure look much sharper and less pixelated when compared to the JPEG. The PNG format also has a better colour depth, meaning that I can have much better quality of the image.

The final reason for choosing PNG is the lossless compression rate. With this, I am able to compress the image to a smaller file size which would allow me to transfer or upload the image faster. However, the compression rate is not as good as the JPEG image, due to the JTAG having lossy compression.

Image Resolution

The resolution that I used for my front page of brochure is 2480 by 3508 and for the brochure which contains rest of the content is 5244 by 2480. The reason that the brochure is this particular resolution is due to the requirements being an A4 sized brochure. However, I did not specifically choose the resolution itself due to the requirements not specifically stating the needed resolution size, instead it requires a page size.

Colour Depth

As I was editing the brochure, I was using a 24 bit colour palette so I could get a very high amount of detail, which is supported by both JPEG and PNG file format. This colour depth allows for the brochure to be very high quality, when used online and when printing out on the CMYK colour model.

By using 24 bit colour, the image had much richer colour that are shown very vibrantly, even after resizing the image. The reason for this is because 24-bit is considered as “true colour”, which is the highest colour depth that the human eye can tell a difference too, so using any higher would be borderline obsolete.

Task 4

(U30:P5) - Modify images as a result of user feedback

Task description: *You are now to review your final product in order to identify any changes that would improve its effectiveness and, having done this, make at least two changes.*

Create a set of questions to help you identify areas for change (e.g. What do you think of the colour scheme? Can you read everything clearly? Etc.)

Question Number	Questions
1.	What was your first impression of the brochure?

2.	How easy was it to read through the brochure?
3.	What do you think of the choice of colours for the brochure?
4.	Is the size of the font suitable?
5.	Are the pages consistent on the brochure?
6.	What is it about the brochure that made you like/dislike it?
7.	How do you think the brochure could be improved when seen from a distance or attracting someone?
8.	In your opinion, what are the strengths of the brochure?
9.	In your opinion, what are the weaknesses of the brochure?

Review your images yourself and with one of your colleagues, using your prepared questions. Document any changes that need to be made and why

Question number	Personal Review	Colleague Review
1	I feel that my brochure is decent and that it has a good amount of colours on it, but I think it might be too much colour.	Your brochure looks very good and modern on my first impression.
2	I found it pretty simple to read through the brochure, I didn't really have any difficulties.	I was able to read through your brochure, but I found it very stale to read through because of the layout of the text.
3	I think the amount of colours is good, but I also feel that the colours might be too much for someone else reading it.	The layout is great and the colour mix very well, but the logo of your brochure mixes too well with the background and I could barely notice it.
4.	I feel that the size of the font is good to read, but I'm not completely sure if it could catch someone's attention.	The text I think the text might be too small and they are not very eye catchy, which made it a bit boring to read.
5.	I feel that the pages on the brochure are very consistent because they contain the same background, theme and the size of the font is the same for each information box.	I think the pages on the brochure are very consistent because the layout looks similar and sleek on most the pages.

6.	What I like about the brochure is the modern and fresh look it has, I feel that it would be aesthetically pleasing when looking at it.	I like how tidy and clean the whole brochure was, keeping the layout consistent and the information is very strong. I didn't like how the text was a bit small and boring to read but that wasn't a massive problem.
7.	I feel that the brochure could do with some tweaks when being seen from a distance, but I think the colours should attract someone's attention.	Maybe having the font slightly bigger and darker as it can be hard to read.
8.	What I believe are the strengths of the brochure is the colours that it has, the text and how easy it is to read and the use of the rectangle tools to make the text stick out more,	The excellent design, the colour, the layout and also the simplicity is what I think are the strengths.
9.	What I believe are the weaknesses of the brochure is that the amount of colours may be disorienting for some people and make it hard to look at.	The text being all the same size and small made it voring to read and the logo on the front was hard to make out because it's the same as the background.

<u>You then need to show that you have identified things to change and made at least two changes to your brochure, providing before and after screenshots</u>

When looking at the feedback, I can find out the strengths and weaknesses of the brochure that which I have created, testing for user friendliness and visual feedback. The test will consist of how the colour scheme, layout, font size, the eye catchiness, consistency and content of the brochure is good for the user experience or needs improvement.

The reason this test and evaluation is being made is so that the brochure can be improved for the user. Since the brochure has just been recently created and that it had no public interacting and visual testing of the brochure, making it possible that it isn't very good for other users. That's why this test and evaluation has been created.

Before

In conclusion of the positives of the brochure that I have gathered, I noticed there were some themes with what was good. The responses that I have received from myself and the user say that the brochure had an excellent design, that the colours and the layout was good, it was clear, the simplicity of the brochure and the "strong" information that was in the brochure.

This means that the user liked the colours, the layout, the clarity and the simplicity of the brochure. These strengths are very good for a brochure because it makes the user like the look of the brochure because of the modern and clean look of the brochure which is considered

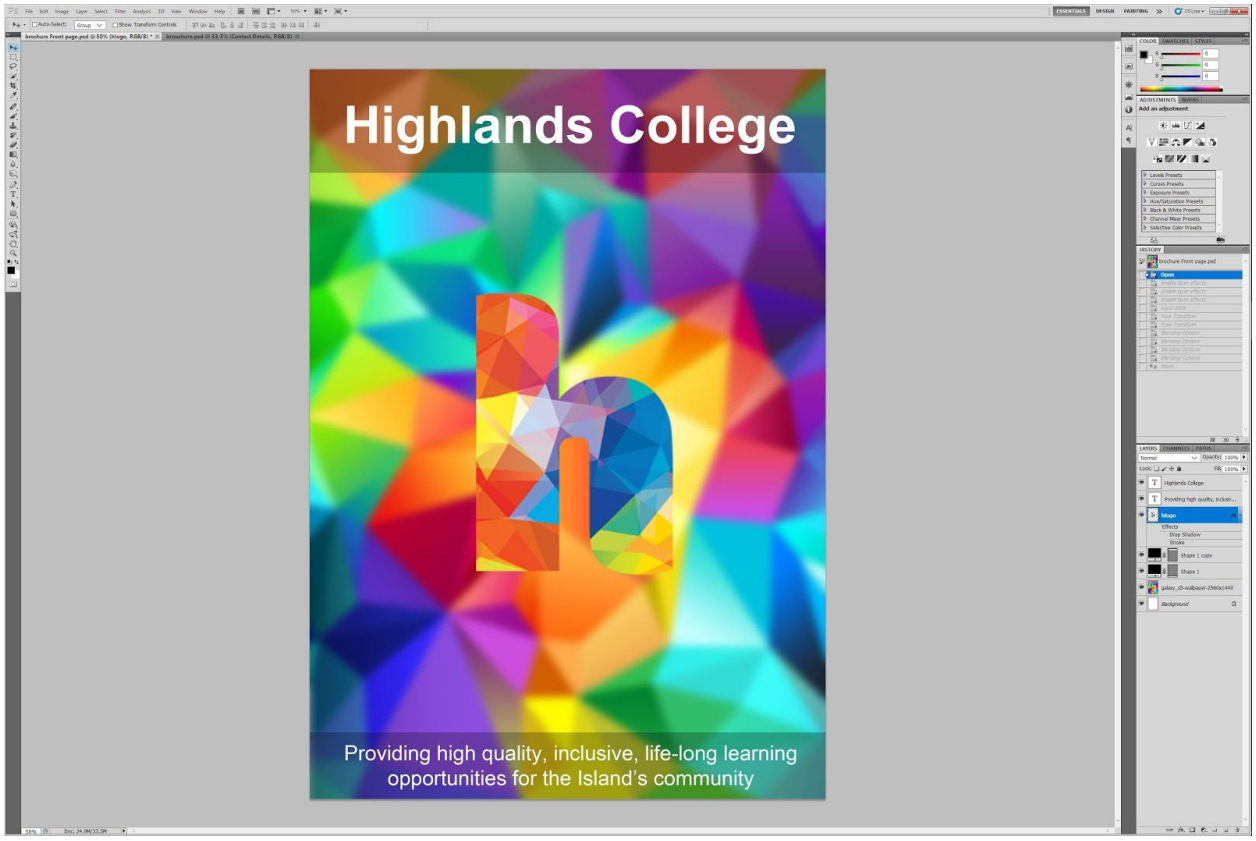
attractive to the users.

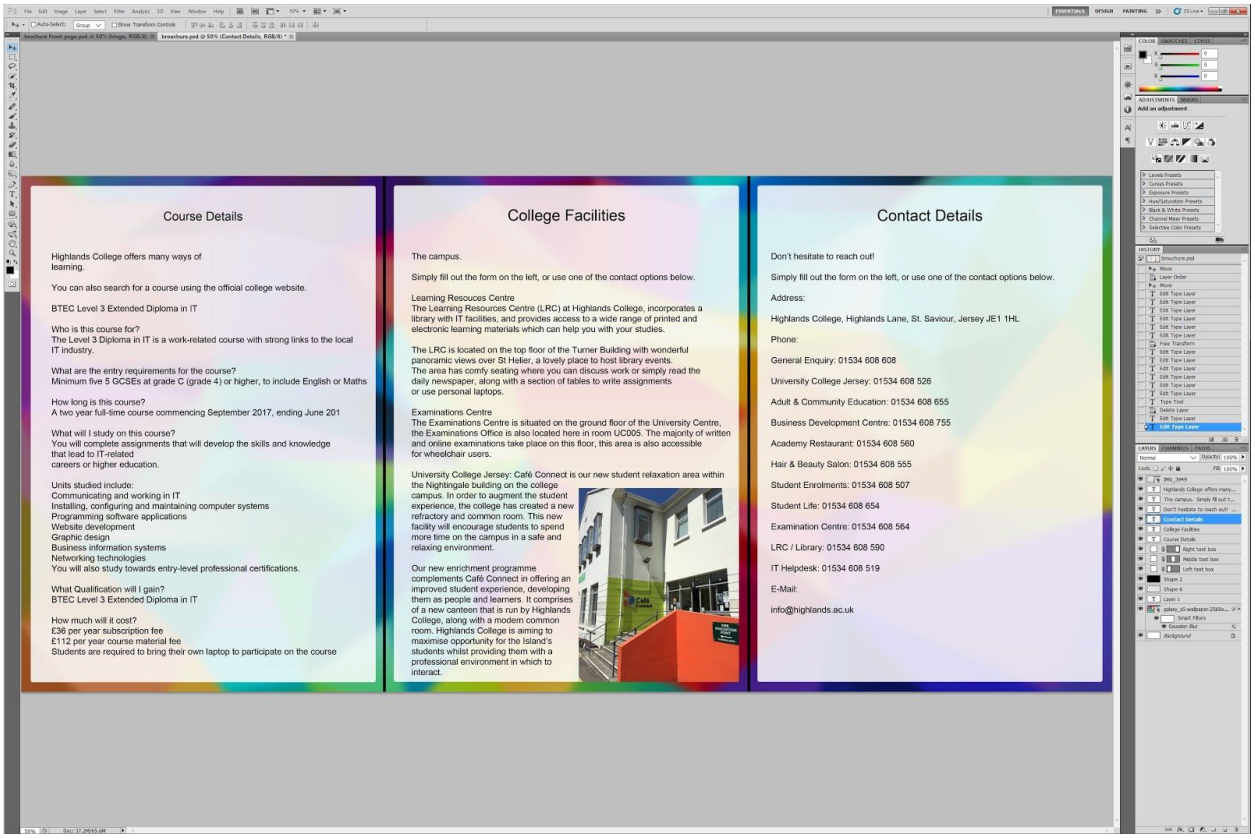
This makes a good brochure because it would make the user want to get a brochure and read through the brochure.

In conclusion of the negatives of the brochure that I have gathered, I noticed there were some themes with what wasn't so good. The responses that has been received from myself and the user say that the weaknesses of the brochure is that there are too many colours on the front page which covers the logo, that the text doesn't stand out well, the font size because it was too small.

This means that the biggest flaw with the brochure is that it had a small font size and that the reviewer wanted more variety in font sizes to reduce confusion, make it look easier on the eyes and to reduce the effort of reading all the text on the page.

The other flaws of the brochure should also be considered, but they aren't as important as the significant flaw that has been spotted out by the majority.





As you can see in the screenshots above, this is the brochure which I had before the user feedback.

On the front page, as the personal and user feedback states, the logo blends in a little too much, making it virtually invisible to a user viewing the brochure from a distance. Which means that the brochure has accidently left one of the key requirements of having the highlands logo on the front page.

This makes it a much more significant issue due to it being a necessary asset to the brochure, which is why this is the first thing I should change when making the improved brochure. Apart from those errors, the front page seems to be very good and does not need any changes.

On the pages that contain content, as the personal and user feedback states, the font is somewhat small and they are all the same size, which makes it hard to distinguish different types of information apart from each other.

However, apart from the errors, the pages that contain the content seem to be good enough for the use of the public and the key requirements it met, meaning that the brochure does fill it's intended purpose well.

After

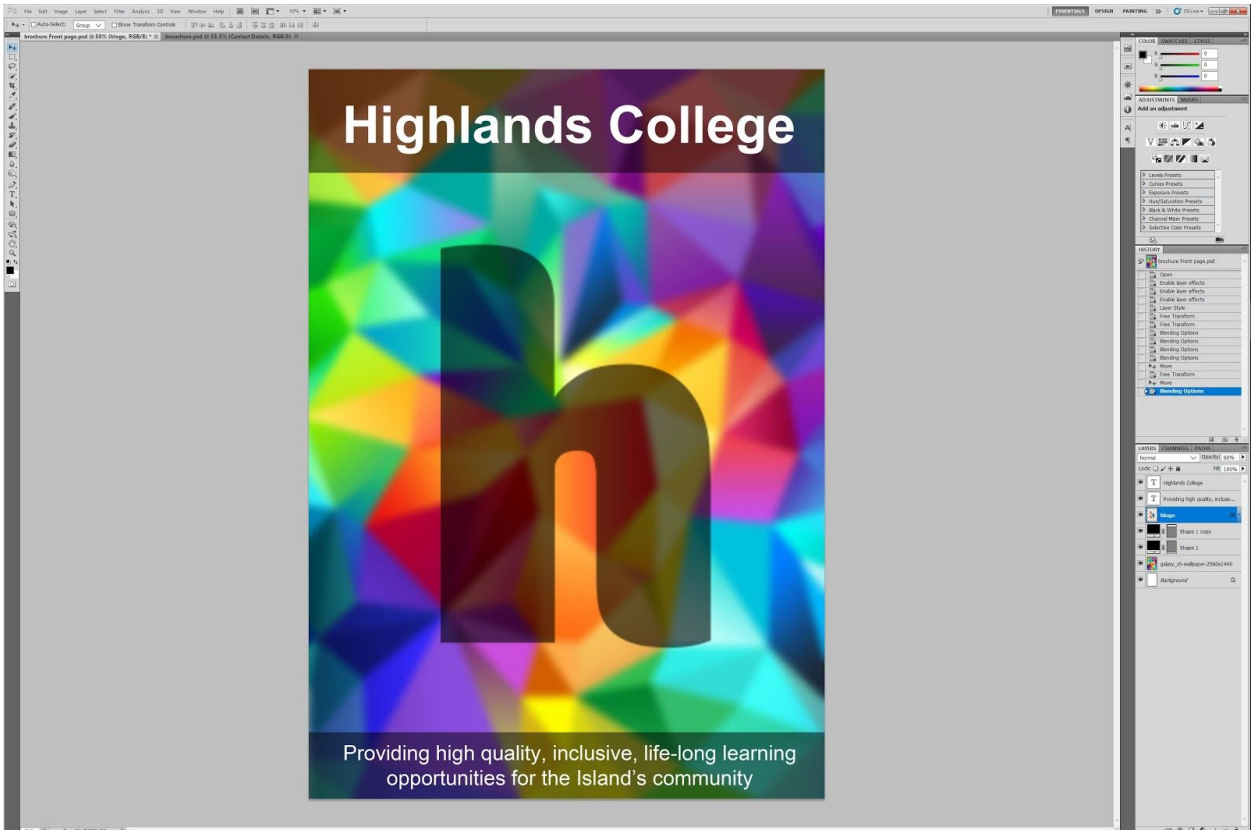
Since the positives and the negatives of the brochure have been reviewed, it is a lot easier to

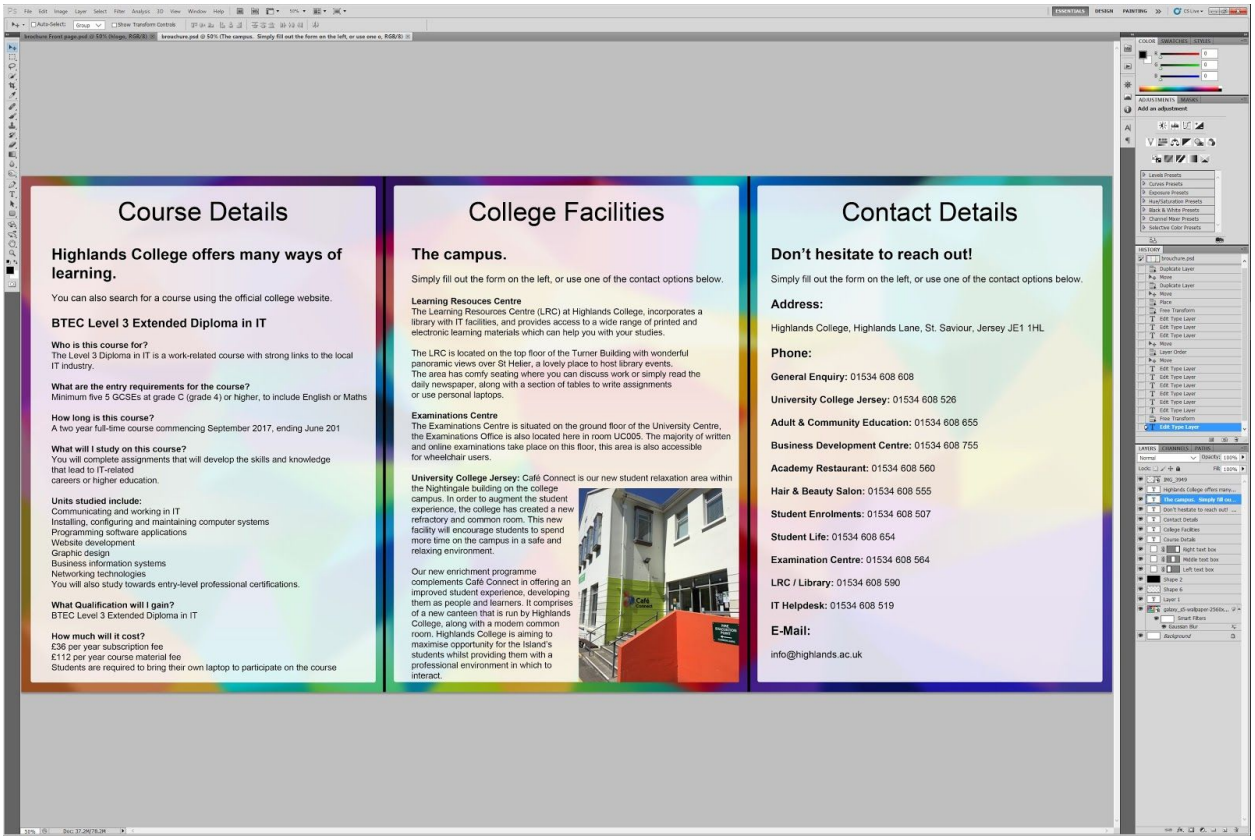
spot out what needs improvements on the brochure itself. Even though there aren't many flaws which the testers and reviewers have pointed out, there are flaws which need to be addressed due to the significance and impact the flaw has on the brochure.

The biggest flaw, the text, needs to be addressed with adjusting the size of the text, so that it could be easy to identify different bits of information. To improve on this, the text should be bigger and bolder depending on what type of information it is, the reason for this is due to the reviewer getting really confused and annoyed at the text being all the same size, which the reviewer had to read the text multiple times to find out what to look for.

Another flaw that seemed to pop up to the reviewer is the brochure having a logo which blended into the background too much. This isn't a hard flaw to fix due to the fact that it has its own layer, making it easier than if it was all one image. To address this flaw, I will need to increase the size of the logo and probably change the colour of the logo itself. However, if this flaw isn't addressed, it is highly likely that someone looking at the brochure from a distance won't know that a logo is even there.

There are other, smaller improvements to the brochure to be made. Such as adding more images or maybe changing the colour scheme a little bit. However, these improvements will mean that the brochure needs to be reworked and tested again and whether the new improvement to the brochure was a good improvement or it made the brochure worse than the original.





As you can see in the screenshots above, this is the brochure which I had after the user feedback.

On the front page, after changing the brochure which the personal and user feedback stated, the logo stands out a lot more when compared to before. Making it visible to a user viewing the brochure from a distance.

Which means that the brochure finally has one of the key requirements of having the highlands logo on the front page, which I have accidently removed by blending the logo in too much. This means that the more significant issues are solved, because it being a necessary asset to the brochure. Which means that any other known changes wouldn't be necessary.

On the pages that contain content, after changing the brochure to fit with what the personal and user feedback stated, the font has different sizes and some are bold, standing out different bits of information and titles. Which makes it a lot easier to distinguish different types of information from each other.

Even though I have fixed the errors that have been found, it doesn't mean that the brochure is perfect, it's far from it. However, the brochure does meet the required standards meaning that the brochure can be used on the website and printed out for use, but this brochure may need a bit more testing in order to make sure that it is good enough for complete public use.